

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Friends in Low Places

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22220-029-friends-in-low-places

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Friends in Low Places

My Son, if sinners entice you, do not give in to them... (Proverbs 1:10)

He who walks with the wise grows wise, but a companion of fools suffers harm. (Proverbs 13:20)

He who keeps the law is a discerning son, but a companion of gluttons disgraces his father. (Proverbs 28:7)

There's a fun country and western song written by Dewayne Blackwell and Bud Lee and sung by Garth Brooks that, without intending to, describes one of life's riskiest entanglements. Called "Friends in Low Places," the ballad proclaims:

*'Cause I've got friends in low places,
Where the whiskey drowns
And the beer chases my blues away.
And I'll be okay.
I'm not big on social graces.
Think I'll slip on down to the oasis.
Oh, I've got friends in low places.*

While the mythical star in the song exults in his scuzzy companions, he's in a very vulnerable situation. The biblical principle is that the friends we choose shape the character we'll possess. Proverbs leads off in chapter one with an admonition to avoid the influence of those who would coax us into doing what is wrong.

Principle: Responding to cautions about unsavory companions with, "I can handle 'em!" is not only naive, but it ignores the spiritual cross-pollination that occurs in relationships.

My grandmother, who had only a fifth-grade education, had a reservoir of wisdom wrapped in down-home proverbs. On friendship, she shared two memorable maxims: "Birds of a feather flock together" and "Water seeks its own level." When I was a college president, I noted the validity of these proverbs in how quickly the new

freshmen who weren't "with the program" spiritually found upperclassmen who shared their contempt for righteousness! They truly did "seek their own [moral and spiritual] level" and soon could be seen "flocking together."

Principle: The associates we choose both reveal and feed the moral appetites of our souls.

My dad told me of the time some of his teenage schoolmates were going out on a Saturday evening of fun, when the leader of the group decided this was the night they would prove their manhood by patronizing a brothel. When my dad discovered this, he got out of the car and walked a number of miles home. Even though he did not know Jesus Christ at that time, that decision, among others, enabled him to marry my mom as a virgin.

Interesting that Solomon and his associates found that even fraternizing with gluttons—not just whoremongers, thieves, or liars—was a moral risk factor. Scary thought in a nation riddled with obesity.

Principle: Sin is extremely contagious and is commonly spread by the infected companions we choose.

So when choosing friends or, for that matter, determining which work associates we will spend our time with, it is best to pick only those who can elevate our moral and spiritual state...true friends in high (heavenly) places.

[from "*Wisdom for the Trenches*" by Dr. Larry W. Poland]

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → jesusonline.com/review

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesusonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesusonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesusonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesusonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping